

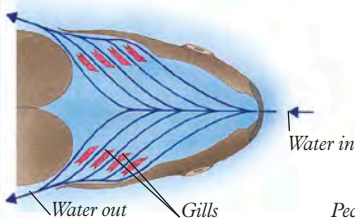
FISH



Fish eggs

Most fish lay jellylike eggs. Some guard their eggs until they hatch. Others, like cod, just squirt millions of tiny eggs into the sea. This is called spawning.

Almost all living things need a gas called oxygen to survive. You cannot see it, but it is found in air and water. You use your lungs to take in oxygen by breathing in air. If you swim under water, you either have to hold your breath or use a snorkel. Fish don't have to do this. They can take their oxygen straight out of the water.



Fish do not need eyelids—seawater keeps their eyes wet and free of dirt.

Pectoral fin

Breathing under water

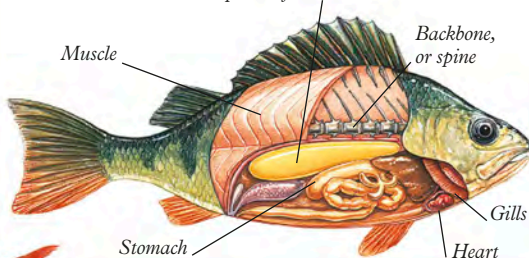
Water flows into the fish's mouth, over red flaps called gills, and out through the gill openings. The gills take the oxygen out of the water.

Bony fish have a "balloon" inside them called a swim bladder. It can be filled with air to help them float.

There are four sets of gills behind this flap.

The pectoral and pelvic fins help the fish move up, down, left, or right.

Pelvic fin



Inside story

Most of the important parts of a bony fish are in the lower half of its body. The top half is full of muscles, which move the tail.